



City Commission Agenda Report

City of Kalamazoo

Date: **6/1/2026**

Item: **H.3.**

TO: Mayor Anderson, Vice Mayor Duncan, and City Commissioners

FROM: Malcolm Hankins, City Manager
Reviewed by: James J. Baker, Public Services Director and City Engineer
Prepared by: Kerry Lyn Williams, Grants Division Manager

DATE: June 1, 2026

SUBJECT: Approval of a contract with Wightman for Construction Engineering for Kalamazoo Avenue (Bid Ref#92549-005.0)

RECOMMENDATION:

It is recommended that the City Commission approve a contract with Wightman for Construction Engineering for Kalamazoo Avenue in the amount of \$2,139,900. (Action: Motion to Approve)

BACKGROUND:

The City of Kalamazoo successfully submitted a Reconnecting Communities Pilot (RCP) grant application to the United States Department of Transportation (US DOT) in October of 2022 and was notified of our selected award in March of 2023. The City Commission accepted this award on June 3, 2024. This grant will combine with local funds to complete construction on Kalamazoo and Michigan Avenues; these projects will

- have significant local and regional impact,
- improve safety and economic opportunities in the city,
- advance equity (correcting segregation resulting from historic redlining barriers),
- support both non-motorized and motorized transportation improvements, and
- Strengthen infrastructure resilience.

Construction of Kalamazoo Avenue is set to commence in July of 2026, with the city hiring a construction engineer contractor to ensure all work is completed in accordance with Michigan Department of Transportation, City of Kalamazoo, and Federal Highway Administration construction standards. The Michigan Department of Transportation let the construction project begin independently in May of 2026.

Five proposals were received by the deadline given in the city's publicly issued and advertised Request for Proposal process. A comprehensive project team was assembled to review and

compare the proposals using an MDOT-approved qualifications-based selection method. Two of the firms submitting proposals were subsequently interviewed. Wightman's proposal had the highest cumulative score and was selected based on its conveyed understanding of the project scope, the firm's experience, and its project delivery abilities.

STRATEGIC VISION ALIGNMENT:

Strategic Goal Impact:

Good Governance— Ensuring the city organization has the capacity and resources to effectively implement the community's strategic vision in a way that is sustainable over the long term.

Connected City—A city networked for walking, biking, riding, and driving.

Economic Vitality—A supportive infrastructure for growing businesses and stabilizing the local economy for the benefit of all.

Inviting Public Places—Vibrant streets, exceptional parks, and welcoming activities.

Safe Community: Creating a safe environment for living, working, and playing.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT:

Appropriate Depth of Engagement

Consult (two-way conversation) – the community will have a chance to react to the project through two-way conversation.

FISCAL IMPACT:

The funds required for this contract are \$2,139,900. Streets and stormwater funds are from the previously approved Reconnecting Communities Pilot (RCP) grant (subrecipient agreement with MDOT). The city has accepted \$1,651,400 of these funds for construction engineering on Kalamazoo Avenue. Remaining funds are not RCP grant-eligible and will be contributed as described in the details below. We are requesting the approval of this purchase using the funds below.

Description	Account	Project #	Dollar Amount
RCP Grant - Major Streets 2026		mst0100293	\$450,400
RCP Grant - Major Streets 2027		mst0100293	\$823,800
RCP Grant - Major Streets 2028		mst0100293	\$226,000
Water CIP - 2026		wat0500424	\$141,900
Water CIP - 2027		wat0500424	\$259,200
Water CIP - 2028		wat0500424	\$71,300
RCP Grant - Stormwater Funds - 2026		mst0100293	\$45,300

RCP Grant - Stormwater Funds - 2027	mst0100293	\$82,800
RCP Grant - Stormwater Funds - 2028	mst0100293	\$23,100
Wastewater CIP - 2026	wwr0200091	\$4,800
Wastewater CIP - 2027	wwr0200091	\$8,500
Wastewater CIP - 2028	wwr0200091	\$2,800